INDEX

Chapter 1	The Hindu Editorial Vocabulary	2-3
Chapter 2	Articles (Reading & Skimming)	4-7
Chapter 3	Descriptive Writing (Letter & Essay)	8-10
Chapter 4	Perfection vocab	16-17
Chapter 5	Perfection(with annotation)pdf	17-24

The Hindu Editorial Vocabulary

Vocabulary:

1. **Meagre (अल्प)** – Lacking in quantity or quality; insufficient.
2. **Bottlenecks (रुकावटें)** – Points of congestion or blockage that slow progress.
3. **Synergy (सहयोग)** – The combined effect of elements that is greater than their individual effects.
4. **Unprecedented (अभूतपूर्व)** – Never done or known before.
5. **Prowess (कौशल)** – Exceptional skill or expertise.
6. **Lofty (उच्च)** – Of great height; noble or ambitious.
7. **Envisage (परिकल्पना करना)** – To imagine or predict a future possibility.
8. **Murky (अस्पष्ट / गंदा)** – Not clear; obscure or suspicious.
9. **Exuberant (उत्साही)** – Full of energy, excitement, and cheerfulness.
10. **Trivial (तुच्छ)** – Of little importance or value.

PHRASAL VERBS:

1. Scrape along
Meaning: Manage with little money

2. Screen out
Meaning: Exclude

3. Screw up
Meaning: Do badly or fail

4. Set about
Meaning: Start doing something

Idioms & Phrases

1. Acid test
Meaning: proves the effectiveness of something

2. Back to basics
Meaning: returning to the simple and most important things

3. Against the clock
Meaning: being rushed and having little time to complete something.

4. Bad apple
Meaning: a discontented, troublemaking, or dishonest person

5. Bee in one's bonnet
Meaning: be preoccupied or obsessed with something

Articles (Reading & Skimming)

Article for Reading:
A gift horse's teeth: on allocations and scientific research

The Budget 2025-26 announcements suggest a potential bonanza for scientific research and development. The Finance Minister outlined ₹20,000 crore budgetary support for developing small modular reactors, with the goal of readying five such reactors by 2033. Another major initiative is the Research, Development, and Innovation fund, included in the Department of Science and Technology (DST)'s expected expenditure. This substantial allocation is expected to benefit start-ups and sunrise sectors, though these remain undefined. The expectation is that private sector entities will receive financial support to boost R&D, a domain historically dominated by government spending. India's R&D landscape has long suffered from low private sector participation. While government funding has driven most scientific advancements, private investment in research has remained inadequate. Currently, private sector R&D contribution is only 36%; overall R&D spending in India was 0.64% of GDP in 2020, the lowest since 1995. Over the last five years, business enterprises have accounted for around 40% of government R&D expenditure. Public sector R&D units allocated only 0.30% of their sales turnover to research, compared to 1.46% by the private sector in 2020-21, according to DST estimates. The government's ₹20,000 crore infusion hikes the DST's total budgetary allocation to around ₹28,000 crore, over three times last year's allocation and seven times the actual expenditure in 2023-24. These figures are encouraging, but a key concern is whether such massive investments can be effectively absorbed. Despite India's strengths in technology-driven sectors such as fuel, metallurgy, pharmaceuticals, textiles, IT, and biotechnology, returns from core R&D and intellectual property generation are still meagre. Though the government has launched ambitious missions in quantum computing, artificial intelligence, and other cutting-edge technologies, the supporting infrastructure remains inadequate. India

still lacks the essential building blocks, chipsets, semiconductor fabs, a skilled engineering workforce, and a strong innovation ecosystem, to fully capitalise on these investments. Without these, the lofty targets set for R&D growth risk falling short. The government must present a clear road map on how private sector entities can access these funds and what tangible benefits the public can expect. Increased funding alone will not guarantee success unless structural bottlenecks are addressed. To truly transform India into a research powerhouse, the focus must shift to strengthening foundational infrastructure, incentivising private innovation, and ensuring long-term, sustainable engagement from industry leaders.

Article for Skimming:

An aerospace expo to further India's global presence

Aero India 2025, which is being held at the Indian Air Force station at Yelahanka in Bengaluru (February 10-14), is more than just an exhibition. It is a platform for innovation, strategic alliances, and technological advancement. The edition this year promises to redefine the standards of aerospace expositions and elevate India's global presence in the aviation sector. As the 15th edition, the show is set to become a landmark event in India's journey towards self-reliance in defence production. Under the leadership of the Prime Minister, Narendra Modi, this premier air show has grown to become a global hub for aerospace innovation, collaboration, and strategic partnerships. The theme this year, 'The Runway to a Billion Opportunities', encapsulates India's commitment to fostering cutting-edge advancements in defence technology while opening new doors for international collaboration. As the Secretary (Defence Production), it is a matter of great pride for this writer to witness the remarkable transformation of India's aerospace and defence manufacturing capabilities. What began in 1996 as a modest aviation exposition, has, today, evolved into one of the most significant global defence events.

With an ever-increasing footprint, Aero India now attracts top-tier defence manufacturers, policymakers, industry leaders and visionaries from across the world. Past editions have witnessed extensive participation from industry players and innovators, and Aero India 2025 is poised to surpass milestones, serving as a dynamic platform to propel India's defence production and technological prowess onto the global stage. Aero India 2025 is set to witness participation from leading global and domestic defence manufacturers, reaffirming its status as a premier defence and aerospace exhibition. A total of 106 original equipment manufacturers (OEMs), including 55 foreign OEMs from 19 countries such as Brazil, France, Israel, Japan, Russia, South Korea, the United Kingdom and the United States have already confirmed their presence. Sixteen defence public sector undertakings (DPSUs) have also confirmed their participation. Additionally, 35 Indian OEMs, including industry giants such as Larsen & Toubro, Bharat Forge Ltd, Adani Defence & Aerospace, Mahindra Defence Systems Limited, BrahMos Aerospace, Ashok Leyland Defence, Bharat Heavy Electricals Limited (BHEL), and Electronics Corporation of India Limited (ECIL), will showcase their cutting-edge advancements, reflecting the growing synergy between the public and private sectors in bolstering India's defence manufacturing ecosystem. For the first time, the exposition will feature two of the world's most advanced fighter jets, the Russian Su-57 and the American F-35. These cutting-edge aircraft will offer aviation experts and enthusiasts a rare opportunity to analyse their capabilities and performance. The Su-57 is engineered for superior stealth and agility, and the F-35 is renowned for its technological superiority. This unprecedented participation signals India's role as a central player in global defence diplomacy and aerospace progress.

Descriptive Writing (Precis writing: & Email Writing)

Original Text:

The silver economy refers to the economic opportunities and challenges associated with an aging population. As life expectancy rises and birth rates decline, many countries are experiencing a demographic shift toward an older population. This shift has significant implications for healthcare, employment, consumer markets, and government policies. The silver economy encompasses industries that cater to the needs of senior citizens, including healthcare, financial services, assistive technologies, housing, and leisure activities. With older individuals having higher disposable incomes and specific needs, businesses are adapting by offering age-friendly products, such as smart healthcare devices, retirement planning services, and accessible infrastructure. Governments are also recognizing the importance of the silver economy. Policies promoting active aging, skill development for older workers, and healthcare innovations can help sustain economic growth while improving the quality of life for seniors. Many countries are investing in geriatric healthcare, social security programs, and digital literacy initiatives to ensure that older citizens remain active participants in society.However, challenges remain, including rising healthcare costs, pension sustainability, and workforce shortages due to declining younger populations. Addressing these issues requires a multi-sectoral approach, combining public policies with private-sector innovation to create a sustainable and inclusive economy for aging societies.

Precis

The silver economy focuses on economic opportunities arising from an aging population, impacting healthcare, finance, housing, and technology. With seniors having higher disposable incomes, businesses are adapting to their needs, while governments invest in healthcare, social security, and digital literacy. Despite opportunities, challenges like rising healthcare costs and pension sustainability persist. A balanced approach involving policy reforms and private-sector innovations is crucial for creating an inclusive and sustainable economy for aging societies.

- **You have received a job offer from ABC Corporation. Write an email to the HR department formally accepting the offer and requesting details about the next steps.**

To: …….@gmail.com

Subject: Acceptance of Job Offer – [Your Name]

Dear [HR Manager's Name],
I hope this email finds you well. I am pleased to formally accept the job offer for the position of [Job Title] at ABC Corporation. I appreciate the opportunity and am excited to contribute to the team. Kindly provide details regarding the next steps, including any required documentation, onboarding procedures, and my start date. Please let me know if there are any forms or formalities I need to complete before joining.

Thank you once again for this opportunity. I look forward to being a part of ABC Corporation.
Best regards,
[Your Name]
[Your Contact Information]

Perfection Vocab

Enrolment – The process of registering for something.

Infrastructure – The basic structures needed for operation.

Indicators – Signs or measurements of a condition.

Pandemic – A widespread outbreak of disease.

Proportion – A part of a whole.

Saturation – The state of being completely full.

Ownership – The right of possessing something.

Substitute – A replacement.

Excitement – A state of enthusiasm.

Underprivileged – Lacking basic necessities.

Accelerate – To speed up.

Constraint – A limitation.

Impediment – A hindrance.

Accessible – Easy to reach or use.

Dictation – Speaking for transcription.

Translation – Converting one language to another.

Broadcast – To transmit information widely.

Vantage – A position offering a good view.

Curriculum – The subjects in an educational program.

Organized – Arranged systematically.

Initially – At the beginning.

Revolutionising – Causing a major change.

Anticipate – To expect or predict.

Ecosystem – A system where elements interact.

Possibilities – Potential opportunities.

Disrupt – To cause disorder.

Implementation – Putting a plan into action.

Enhancement – An improvement.

Inevitable – Certain to happen.

Integration – Combining different elements.

Turbulence – A state of disorder.

Dissatisfaction – A lack of contentment.

Scrutiny – Close inspection.

Aspiration – A strong desire to achieve.

Productivity – Efficiency in producing results.

Functionalities – Capabilities of a system.

Transformational – Causing a big improvement.

Probe – An official investigation.

Bundling – Selling multiple things together.

Dominance – Being most powerful.

Monopoly – Exclusive control of a market.

Regulation – Rules set by authorities.

Compliance – Following rules.

Litigation – Legal action.

Predecessor – Something that came before.

Trajectory – The path of progress.

Mantra – A guiding phrase or belief.

Iteration – Repeating a process.

Reliability – Dependability.

Transparency – Openness in communication.

Competitive – Striving for superiority.

Obsolete – No longer in use.

Strategic – Related to planning.

Culmination – The final stage of something.

Determination – Firmness of purpose.

Perseverance – Persistence despite difficulties.

Stepping Stone – A means of progress.

Temporary – Lasting for a short time.

Obstacles – Things that block progress.

Mindset – A way of thinking.

Resilience – The ability to recover.

Challenges – Difficulties requiring effort.

Motivation – The reason for doing something.

Define – To explain the meaning.

Achievement – A successful result.

Destination – The goal or endpoint.

Journey – The process of progress.

Growth – Increase in size or development.

Improvement – A positive change.

Confidence – Self-assurance.

Self-discipline – Controlling one’s actions.

Endurance – The ability to withstand hardship.

Adaptability – The ability to adjust.

Constructive – Beneficial for progress.

Dedication – Commitment to a purpose.

Innovation – New ideas or methods.

Ambition – A strong desire to succeed.

Competence – The ability to do something well.

Empowerment – Gaining confidence and strength.

Perspective – A way of viewing things.

Self-awareness – Understanding oneself.

Inspiration – Mental stimulation to act.

Legacy – Something left for future generations.

Groundbreaking – Innovative and new.

Captivated – Fascinated.

Pledging – Making a formal promise.

Acclaim – Public praise.

Metropolises – Large cities.

Procurement – The act of obtaining something.

Commerce – Buying and selling activities.

Existential – Related to existence.

Conglomerate – A large business group.

Plight – A difficult situation.

Intensifies – Becomes stronger.

Monopolies – Markets controlled by one entity.

Retailers – Businesses selling goods.

Sustainability – The ability to continue over time.

Pivot – A fundamental change in approach.

Competitive Edge – An advantage over others.

Adaptation – Adjusting to new conditions.

Footholds – Secure positions.

Obliterate – To destroy completely.

Supremacy – Being superior.

Viability – Ability to succeed.

Grievances – Complaints.

Undermine – To weaken gradually.

Incentivize – To encourage with rewards.

Regulatory – Related to rules.

Opposition – Resistance.

Disruptive – Causing disturbance.

Proliferation – Rapid increase.

Perfection(with annotation)pdf

In India, the 1990s and the early 2000s were a time of education activities on a mass scale. But results from the nationwide Annual Status of Education Report (ASER) surveys of that period indicated that while enrolment and infrastructure indicators ___**(A)**___, learning indicators pointed to no change. At the same time, computers, mobile phones, and digital technology were making waves. It was a time of many possibilities and promises with digital solutions and businesses. However, it was when the COVID-19 pandemic struck that the digital revolution hit the ground in rural India. This is reflected very well in ASER data. In 2018, nearly 90% of rural households had simple mobile phones and 36% had smartphones. In 2022, the proportion of households with smartphones had risen to over 74% and, according to ASER 2024, it has grown further to 84% this year. While the percentage of children who have access to a smartphone at home is nearing saturation, the proportion of children aged between 14 and 16 years who own a smartphone has risen from 19% to about 31% within a year. It is not clear from the ASER data whether mothers of young children have their own phones.

Digital technology

This ownership of smartphones is important when it comes to use in supporting young children's learning and their own learning. The main use of smartphones during the pandemic period was that of a carrier of texts, worksheets, and videos, which were a substitute for textbooks. Virtual training sessions had become common too. As the pandemic faded away, the digital skills learned during the period sustained, although some of the practices became less important and a new excitement began to build around artificial intelligence (AI). The best promise of the digital revolution was, to this writer, in the open and continuing education domain for the underprivileged. The need and the possibilities in India are tremendous. For example, at this time, over 40% mothers of schoolchildren are not schooled or have completed school less than class five. Nearly another 40% are schooled between class six and class 10, and the remaining have completed class 10. Educating mothers so that they can help children is an investment India should make to accelerate and strengthen the education of children. Over the past 30 years, we have lived through the computer, the Internet, and mobile revolutions, and we are now looking at AI.

A3

Mothers

M.9 - Technology - Available 45sec

With every new wave of technology, there is new hope and talk of revolutionising education. By the time the technology becomes affordable, something new and exciting for the privileged shows up on the horizon, but technology has not delivered on its promise where the education of the underprivileged is concerned. One of the biggest constraints is the availability of devices. But, as ASER 2024 data show, availability of individually owned smartphones is going to be less and less of a constraint. Most rural households already have a smartphone. Getting a second phone may be easier for many families in times to come. Hardware, without a doubt, is becoming easily available. Language used to be a major **impediment**. It is not so any more. Writing or dictation in local languages is now possible. Translation from one language to another is easy. All the tools needed for learning are accessible, if you know what to access, where, and how.

But what if there was one place in a village — let us call it school — where questions of what, where, and how were answered by an intelligent device? Access to schools is complete. But school attendance is still a problem.

→ M.9

In a village or a community, some children go to a private school, some to a government school, others to private classes and some do not go to school at all. This is somewhat of a **chaotic** situation at the level of the village and also at the larger community level, which reflects in the quality of learning in schools.

During the pandemic, in many villages of Maharashtra, a learning programme was broadcast from a vantage point. It should be possible to work out a curriculum and broadcast schedule in villages so that group learning can be organised. Organising new schools in this manner should be possible, although, initially, there may not be many takers.

— M.9

20sec

But results from the nationwide Annual Status of Education Report (ASER) surveys of that period indicated that while enrolment and infrastructure indicators ___**(A)**___, learning indicators pointed to no change.

Question 1:

Choose the most suitable phrasal verb to fill the given **blank (A)** to make the sentence grammatically and contextually correct.

I. showed a rush to schools

II. demonstrated significant improvement

III. remained stagnant

no change

(a) Both II and III

(b) Both I and II

(c) Only III

(d) Both I and III

(e) Only I

Question 2:

Which of the following is the **"TRUE"** statement based on the given passage?

True

I. The COVID-19 pandemic accelerated the adoption of digital technology in rural India.

II. The proportion of rural households with smartphones increased from 36% in 2018 to 74% in 2024. False

2022

84%.

III. During the pandemic, smartphones were mainly used as alternatives to textbooks.

(a) Only III

(b) Both I and II

(c) Both II and III

(d) Both I and III

(e) All I, II and III

d

Question 3:

mothers – education

What shift in approach does the passage likely to advocate for in relation to education in rural India?

Inference

I. Increasing access to smartphones for mothers to support children's learning.

II. Using smartphones as a tool for open and continuing education for the underprivileged.

III. Organising group learning through broadcast programmes in villages.

(a) Only I

(b) Both I and II

(c) Both II and III

(d) Only II

(e) All I, II and III

Question 4:

Which of the following is the **"FALSE"** statement based on the given passage?

I. The proportion of children aged 14-16 who own a smartphone increased from 19% to 31% within a year.

True

II. Language is no longer a major impediment to learning due to advancements in technology. – True

III. School attendance in rural India is no longer a problem.

False

20 - 30 days

40 days

(a) Only I

(b) Both II and III

(c) Only II

(d) Both I and III

(e) Only III

Question 5:

What is the **tone** of the given passage?

I. Analytical

II. Cynical

III. Optimistic

(a) only III

(b) Both II and III

(c) only I

(d) Both I and III

(e) All I, II and III

Hardware, without a doubt, is becoming easily available. Language used to be a major **impediment**. It is not so any more.

Question 6:

Which of the following options can be the appropriate **Synonym(s)** of the word **'impediment'**, as used in the above passage?

I. deterrent

II. encumbrance

III. expedition

(a) Both I and II

(b) Only II

(c) Both II and III

(d) Only I

(e) All I, II and III

Adj confusing

This is somewhat of a **chaotic** situation at the level of the village and also at the larger community level, which reflects in the quality of learning in schools.

Question 7:

Which of the following options can be the appropriate **Antonym(s)** of the word **'chaotic'**, as used in the above passage?

I. tumultuous

II. harmonious

III. regimented

chaotic – Syno

Adj – peaceful, tranquil, serene

– controlled, ordered

Anto

(a) Only I

(b) Both II and III

(c) Only II

(d) Both I and II

(e) All I, II and III

Set-2

Direction (8-13): Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions given below.

5-7 min

RC

Microsoft's ambitious integration of artificial intelligence (AI) through its Copilot software suite has encountered significant turbulence, marked by customer dissatisfaction and intensified regulatory scrutiny. These challenges _(A)_ the company's efforts to position itself at the forefront of AI-driven enterprise solutions. Introduced as an AI-powered assistant across Microsoft's product ecosystem, Copilot aims to enhance user productivity by automating tasks and providing intelligent insights. However, its performance has yet to consistently meet user expectations. Reports indicate that customers find Copilot's functionalities could be more impressive, and some are considering alternative solutions. Salesforce CEO Marc Benioff likened Microsoft's Copilot to the infamous Clippy, suggesting it failed to deliver substantial value to users. Clippy was a failed assistive platform that Microsoft introduced in 1997. After a quarter of a century, Benioff feels that the company has been unable to deliver anything with substantially greater functionality than that failure from years past delivered to customers at the time. The Salesforce CEO concluded:

"I have yet to find anyone who's had a transformational experience with Microsoft Copilot or the pursuit of training and retraining custom LLMs." To be fair, Benioff has his fish to fry; he thinks his product Agentforce is vastly superior. Agentforce allows users to build their own AI agents to fold into their onsite infrastructure.Compounding the challenges, the US Federal Trade Commission (FTC) has launched a comprehensive antitrust investigation into Microsoft. The probe examines the company's cloud computing, software licensing, cybersecurity, and AI products including Copilot. David McCabe of The New York Times has this to say: "Of particular interest to the FTC is the way that Microsoft bundles its cloud computing offerings with office and security products, they added, alongside the company's growing power in the artificial intelligence space." This investigation aligns with the FTC's broader initiative to **scrutinise** potential anti-competitive practices in the tech industry. Under chair Lina Khan, the agency has intensified efforts to regulate Big Tech, focusing on how companies leverage their market positions to stifle competition.

For Microsoft, this scrutiny could impede its strategy of bundling Copilot with its widely used enterprise software, a move that competitors argue could unfairly consolidate its dominance. Moreover, the FTC's investigation could restrict how Microsoft integrates Copilot into its software offerings. Potential outcomes include mandates to unbundle AI features or modify licensing agreements to foster fair competition. Such measures could disrupt Microsoft's plans to embed AI deeply into its ecosystem, affecting its competitive edge in the burgeoning AI market. The FTC has had similar investigations and lawsuits against Amazon, Apple, Google, and Meta, alleging unfair trade practices. That said, FTC chair Khan's days at the agency's helm are probably numbered; she could lose her job in the transition to the new administration, whose	priorities in regulating Big Tech are unknown. The New York Times piece highlights that the FTC antitrust activity against Google and Meta was initiated during the US President-elect's last administration.

The convergence of customer dissatisfaction and regulatory challenges presents a **formidable** obstacle to Microsoft's AI aspirations. The company's approach of rapidly deploying AI features across its product suite has been criticised for prioritising market presence over product readiness. The internal mantra of "**building the plane as we fly it**" underscores a strategy that may have overlooked thorough testing and user feedback. These are red flags for any company attempting to build reliable software products. While it is natural to expect bugs to occur when software is built, releasing buggy software without meaningful functionality enhancements is a sure-fire recipe for product failure.To address these issues, Microsoft must adopt a more measured approach to AI integration, emphasising product reliability and user	satisfaction. Engaging with customers to gather feedback and iterating on Copilot's features could enhance its utility and restore confidence. Simultaneously, Microsoft must cooperate transparently with regulatory bodies, demonstrating a commitment to fair competition.

This may involve reassessing its bundling strategies and ensuring that its market practices do not hinder competitors. While Microsoft's Copilot initiative can represent a significant leap toward AI-enhanced productivity if done right, its current trajectory is fraught with challenges. Balancing innovation with responsibility, competitiveness, and fairness will be crucial for Microsoft to navigate this complex landscape and achieve its AI ambitions. It appears that many, including some inside the company, think it's falling short. And with its value-sensitive customers in India, this will be even more of a setback.

- M — (-ve)
- FTC —
- Suggestion

These challenges (-ve) **_(A)_** the company's efforts to position itself at the forefront of AI-driven enterprise solutions.

Question 8:

Choose the most suitable phrase to fill the given **blank (A)** to make the sentence grammatically and contextually correct.

I. cast a shadow over — (-ve)

II. burn the midnight oil on (+ve)

III. put a damper on — (-ve)

(a) Both I and II

(b) Both II and III

(c) Only I

(d) Both I and III

(e) Only III

Question 9:

Which of the following is the **"TRUE"** statement based on the given passage?

I. Microsoft's Copilot has received minimal praise for providing transformative experiences to users.

II. The FTC is particularly focused on Microsoft's bundling of cloud services with Office and security products.

III. Salesforce CEO Marc Benioff believes that Microsoft's Copilot is inferior to Salesforce's Agentforce.

(a) Only III

(b) Both I and II

(c) Both II and III

(d) Both I and III

(e) All I, II and III

Question 10:

Which of the following is the **"FALSE"** statement based on the given passage?

I. Microsoft focused on establishing a market presence rather than ensuring product maturity.

II. Soliciting customer feedback and iterating on Copilot's capabilities could boost its value and restore confidence.

III. Microsoft's Copilot is on track to enhance productivity and address challenges.

(a) Only I

(b) Both I and II

(c) Both II and III

(d) Only III

(e) None of I, II and III

The internal mantra of "**building the plane as we fly it**" underscores a strategy that may have overlooked thorough testing and user feedback.

Question 11:

What does the phrase **"building the plane as we fly it"** imply about Microsoft's approach to AI?

a) A methodical strategy ensuring that AI features are fully tested before deployment

b) A cautious and research-driven model focused on minimizing errors

c) A rushed approach where AI features are integrated without thorough testing

d) A deliberate delay in launching AI products to perfect their functionalities

e) A philosophy that values product reliability over market expansion

This investigation aligns with the FTC's broader initiative to **scrutinise** potential anti-competitive practices in the tech industry.

Question 12:

Which of the following options can be the appropriate **Synonym(s)** of the word "**scrutinise**", as used in the above passage?

I. epitomise

II. dissect

III. interpolate

(a) Both I and III

(b) Only II

(c) Both I and II

(d) Only III

(e) All I, II and III

The convergence of customer dissatisfaction and regulatory challenges presents a **formidable** obstacle to Microsoft's AI aspirations.

menacing
threatening

Question 13:

Which of the following options can be the appropriate **Antonym(s)** of the word **'formidable'**, as used in the above passage?

I. feeble – weak

II. mild – weak

III. indomitable – strong

(a) Only I

(b) Both II and III

(c) Only II

(d) Both I and II

(e) All I, II and III

Success is often perceived as the **[A] culmination** of hard work, determination, and perseverance. However, it is also important to recognize the role of failure in achieving success. **[B]** Failure is not the opposite of success; rather, it is a stepping stone about it. Every failure provides an opportunity to learn, grow, and improve. When faced with **[C]** _ , it is crucial to maintain a positive mindset and view them as temporary obstacles rather than permanent roadblocks. By analyzing what went wrong and making necessary adjustments, one can turn failure into a valuable learning experience. Moreover, resilience plays a key role in overcoming challenges. **[D]** *Resilient individuals do not let failure define* ***(p)****/ it;*

Reading - 1 min

instead, they use it ***(q)****/ as motivation to strive harder* ***(r)****/ and achieved their goals.* ***(s)***

Ultimately, success is not just about reaching the destination but also about the journey and the lessons learned along the way.

Success is often perceived as the **[A] culmination** of hard work, determination, and perseverance. **Question 14:** In the following question, a bolded word **[A]** is provided, followed by four options, each presenting a pair of words. Select the option that includes a synonym and also choose an idiom that conveys the context of the highlighted word, respectively. **Mark "E" if none of the options corresponds to the context.**	(a) affliction, the last straw (b) crest, the icing on the cake (c) outset, a blessing in disguise (d) breakdown, a bitter pill to swallow (e) None of the above

However, it is also important to recognize the role of failure in achieving success. **[B]** Failure is not the opposite of success; rather, it is a stepping stone ~~about~~ it. **Question 15:** Select the appropriate replacement for the underlined segment **[B]** of the sentence to ensure both grammatical accuracy and contextual coherence. (a) Failure is not the opposite of success; rather, it is a stepping stone to it. (b) Failure is not the opposite of success; rather, it is a stepping stone for it.	(c) Failure is not the opposite of success; rather, it is a stepping stone into it. (d) Failure is not the opposite of success; rather, it is a stepping stone in it. (e) No improvement is required.

When faced with **[C]** _ , it is crucial to maintain a positive mindset and view them as temporary obstacles rather than permanent roadblocks.

Question 16:

Choose the most suitable sentence that should be filled in the given blank **[C]** to make the sentence grammatically and contextually correct.

I. refinement

II. setbacks

III. headway

(a) Only I

(b) Only III

(c) Only II

(d) Both I and II

(e) Both I and III

Moreover, resilience plays a key role in overcoming challenges. **[D]** *Resilient individuals do not let failure define* ***(p)****/ it, instead, they use it* ***(q)****/ as motivation to strive harder* ***(r)****/ and achieved their goals.*

Question 17:

The given sentence **[D]** is divided into four parts: '(p)', '(q)', '(r)', and '(s)' respectively; there may be errors in one, two, three, or all four parts. You have to select the number of errors in the above sentences, mark the number as your answer. Mark "e" if "no error."

(a) Only one

(b) Only two

(c) Only three

(d) All four

(e) No error

Directions (1-7): **Read the following passage and answer the given questions.**

In a groundbreaking move in 2024, Blinkit, a rapid-delivery platform, captivated public attention by pledging to deliver Apple's latest iPhone 16 series within mere minutes. The initiative was met with widespread acclaim across digital forums but provoked resentment among conventional smartphone retailers. Initially, Blinkit facilitated the procurement of the iPhone 16 series in metropolises such as Delhi NCR, Mumbai, Pune, and Bengaluru. While consumers extolled the unparalleled convenience, brick-and-mortar vendors decried the initiative, fearing an existential threat to their commerce.Reports indicate that prominent smartphone conglomerates—including Samsung, Motorola, Itel, Lava, POCO, and Xiaomi—have commenced listing their merchandise on burgeoning rapid - commerce platforms like Zepto, further exacerbating the plight of offline merchants. Recently, Vivo also integrated its Y18i and Y29 models onto these platforms, incentivizing purchases exceeding ₹5,000 with an exclusive 5% ICICI Bank rebate.The escalation of this trend follows Blinkit's successful execution of swift iPhone deliveries, prompting an industry-wide pivot toward quick-commerce. Within months, nearly all major mobile manufacturers have aligned themselves with such platforms, capitalizing on their instantaneous fulfillment models.

For years, conventional retailers have vehemently opposed e-commerce behemoths such as Flipkart and Amazon, alleging that these digital monopolies prioritize volume over vendor equity. The proliferation of quick-commerce further intensifies their grievances, as they fear irreversible **market erosion.** Additionally, they assert that these ventures inadvertently bolster illicit trade channels while undermining longstanding consumer trust. The All India Mobile Retailers Association (AIMRA), representing 1.5 lakh retailers, has voiced strident opposition to this paradigm shift. AIMRA contends that rapid - delivery platforms neither enhance brand prestige nor foster sustainable sales trajectories; rather, they

Blinkit E-C TS

Rel

Blinkit Zepto - Quick commerce

jeopardize the stability of established retail ecosystems. In a formal communiqué addressed to Vivo India's CEO, Jerome Chen, AIMRA's national joint secretary, Navneet Pathak, underscored that Vivo's ascendancy to the apex of India's smartphone hierarchy was largely facilitated by traditional retail partnerships.Industry experts are divided on the implications. Faisal Kawoosa, founder of TechArc, aligns with retailers, affirming that quick-commerce undermines their competitive edge—namely, immediate product availability. Conversely, proponents argue that by 2025, rapid-delivery platforms will dominate the sale of diverse electronic peripherals, such as smartwatches, TWS earbuds, and computing accessories. Major laptop manufacturers, including HP, Lenovo, Acer, and Asus, have already embraced this shift, with HP and Acer	establishing footholds on Blinkit, Zepto, and Flipkart Minutes.Despite apprehensions, analysts predict that quick-commerce entities will primarily challenge e-commerce giants rather than obliterate traditional retail, gradually cementing their market supremacy.

Q1.**Considering the implications of rapid-delivery platforms, which of the following most accurately encapsulates the apprehensions of conventional retailers?** spread **(I)** The proliferation of instant commerce is perceived as an existential disruption by traditional smartphone merchants, exacerbating their antagonism toward digital marketplaces. **(II)** The widespread assimilation of quick-commerce into mainstream consumer behavior is expected to accelerate the attrition of offline sales, mirroring the trajectory of e-commerce expansion. path based **(III)** The dominance of rapid-delivery platforms is predicated primarily on aggressive price undercutting, rendering conventional retail models unviable. mainly impractical	**(a)** Only (I) **(b)** Both (I) and (II) **(c)** Only (III) **(d)** Both (II) and (III) **(e)** All (I), (II), and (III)

Q2.**What can be discerned regarding the strategic alignment of mobile manufacturers in response to the advent of quick-commerce?**

(I) Prominent mobile manufacturers are proactively integrating rapid-delivery services into their sales frameworks, recognizing them as lucrative distribution channels.

(II) Major smartphone brands, including Vivo and Xiaomi, have exhibited overt reluctance to engage with quick-commerce due to potential backlash from brick-and-mortar retailers.

(III) The accelerated industry-wide transition toward rapid-commerce is largely attributable to Blinkit's pioneering success in expediting iPhone deliveries.

(a) Only (I)
(b) Both (I) and (III)
(c) Only (III)
(d) Both (II) and (III)
(e) All (I), (II), and (III)

Q3.**What underlying stance does AIMRA adopt concerning the encroachment of quick-commerce into the smartphone retail ecosystem?**

(I) The association posits that the advent of quick-commerce fortifies the accessibility and premium positioning of smartphone brands.

(II) AIMRA perceives the surge of rapid-delivery platforms as a destabilizing force that jeopardizes the equilibrium of the established retail hierarchy.

(III) AIMRA maintains that traditional retail partnerships have been instrumental in propelling brands such as Vivo to market dominance in India.

(a) Only (I)
(b) Both (I) and (III)
(c) Only (III)
(d) Both (II) and (III)
(e) All (I), (II), and (III)

Q4.**Evaluate the veracity of the following assertions regarding the transformative impact of rapid-delivery commerce on the smartphone retail ecosystem:**

(I) The proliferation of quick-commerce platforms is perceived by conventional vendors as a destabilizing force that erodes their market foothold and diminishes their competitive leverage.

(II) The rise of quick-commerce has unequivocally supplanted both traditional and e-commerce retail models, rendering them obsolete in the smartphone distribution landscape.

(III) AIMRA contends that rapid-delivery platforms contribute negligibly to brand equity and long-term sales sustainability, instead fostering market volatility.

(a) Only (I) is true
(b) Both (I) and (III) are true
(c) Only (II) is true
(d) Both (II) and (III) are true
(e) All (I), (II), and (III) are false

Q5.**Evaluate the accuracy of the following assertions concerning the competitive positioning of rapid-delivery platforms in the global electronics marketplace:**

(I) Quick-commerce has emerged as a formidable contender against traditional retail and is projected to rival major e-commerce entities in the near future.

(II) Despite opposition from conventional vendors, industry analysts foresee quick-commerce platforms integrating seamlessly with global supply chains.

(III) The rapid adoption of instant-delivery models is expected to completely supplant conventional sales channels, rendering physical stores redundant.

(a) Only (I) is true
(b) Only (III) is true
(c) Both (I) and (II) are true
(d) Both (I) and (III) are true
(e) All (I), (II), and (III) are false

Q6. **The passage discusses the competitive positioning of quick-commerce platforms in relation to both traditional retail and e-commerce giants. Which of the following statements can be logically inferred by integrating multiple aspects of the discussion?**

(I) The expansion of quick-commerce is not solely a threat to traditional retailers but also positions itself as a direct competitor to established e-commerce giants.
(II) Traditional retailers have begun leveraging quick-commerce models themselves to maintain their competitive edge in the smartphone and electronics market.
(III) The adoption of quick-commerce has led to an overall reduction in consumer reliance on both traditional retail and e-commerce platforms, making quick-commerce the dominant sales channel.

(a) Only (I)
(b) Both (I) and (III)
(c) Only (III)
(d) Both (II) and (III)
(e) All (I), (II), and (III)

The proliferation of quick-commerce further intensifies their grievances, as they fear irreversible **market erosion.**

Q7. **Which of the following scenarios best illustrates the concept of market erosion?**

(a) A new competitor enters the market, forcing existing businesses to lower their prices to remain competitive.
(b) A major company expands its global presence, acquiring smaller businesses in multiple regions.
(c) An established business invests in cutting-edge technology, solidifying its market dominance.
(d) A sudden shift in government policy boosts domestic production, leading to an increase in market share for local businesses.
(e) A company successfully rebrands itself, attracting a new customer base while retaining its existing market presence.